

As we continued to chat about nothing in particular, I began to think that Ms. Jayson-Koerber *was* auric. Frankly, I felt she was crawling into my ear. No doubt this was my own imagination hard at work, stimulated by the fear that Ms. Jayson-Koerber might already have learned some terrible thing about me that I didn't know myself. My nervousness caused me to blurt out: "When you find those bodies, aren't you afraid that the killers will want to come after you?" Ms. Jayson-Koerber said this was a very negative question, and from the tone of her voice you'd have thought that I'd just stabbed her myself. That was the end of any worthwhile exchange between us.

After that, I called Bill Attride, a professional astrologer who lived in Brooklyn. He gave me a free half hour on the phone, for which I'm grateful. Mr. Attride said some very provocative things. For example, he'd studied economics in graduate school and found it to be a sloppy pseudoscience, full of wives' tales and irrational thinking, while astrology had proven to be more rigorous, sensible, and practical in every respect. "That's because economists are only working with the phenomena," he explained. "Astrologers go beyond the phenomena and get right into the numena."

*Numena*, I found out later, means "the heart of things." Mr. Attride mentioned a client of his, an ex-broker at Shearson, who'd been very bullish on a small bioengineering company until Mr. Attride did a background investigation into its numena. While many analysts had liked this stock, Mr. Attride found unfavorable cosmic alignments. He talked his friend out of buying it, which was a lucky thing, since the company suddenly went bankrupt.

I asked Mr. Attride if he had any numatic explanation for what had happened between me and Angstrom—since to date the stock price was well below where I'd bought it. He said to make such a judgment wouldn't be easy. First, I'd have to call Angstrom and also my mother, asking both sources for relevant birthdays, dates and times of incorporations, days when stocks were split, the exact hour I was born, and other critical details.

If I'd bring all this data back to Mr. Attride, he'd do birth charts for the company itself, for as many principal officers as possible, and also for me. Only then could he analyze the interplanetary conflicts, negative or positive aspects of Saturn or Uranus, the